

thing if he didn't put in the work to earn his wins. Before he retired, Phelps practiced up to six hours a day, six days a week, during peak training times. He swam nearly fifty miles a week. He had a rigorous weight-lifting routine. He had one of the most challenging nutritional plans of any athlete, consuming twelve thousand calories a day. He prioritized rest and recovery. He would write his goals down and put them where he could see them every day.^{8, 9} For nearly twenty years, this man spent all day, every day thinking about and fine-tuning his body for swimming. Sure, he has some genetic advantages, but none of those things would have mattered if he hadn't worked—and worked *hard*—for his success.

Some people, though, overlook how hard Michael Phelps worked to be the best in his sport. They think his winning streak was based on nothing but luck because of his genetic makeup. That's how a lot of people see millionaires too. They think the typical millionaire just dove into a pile of money with no hard work, no plan, and no effort. They chalk it up to luck or the lottery. That idea—the notion that wealthy people are simply lucky lottery winners, married into money, or have some genetic advantage that normal people don't have—is a myth, and it's one that will keep you from ever becoming a millionaire yourself if you believe it.